

SURREY SCOUT

NOVEMBER, 1979

No. 389

County Commissioner

On the last Sunday in each month, eleven months of twelve and whatever the weather, Doug Bennett sets off at about 5.30 in the morning on his "post round" of the County. The following month's edition of "Surrey Scout", agendas and minutes of committee meetings, notifications and entry forms for forthcoming events are all part of his post-bag to be dropped off to District distributors during the course of the morning - or "middle of the night" as some might rightly think.

Doug goes to considerable trouble, with personal inconvenience, to undertake this task and we have every cause to be grateful to him.

But is it all a waste of time?

Just how long does it take for "Surrey Scout", for example, to arrive in the hands of each Scouter in each Group throughout the County of Surrey? How long is it before those entry forms for County and other events actually reach those who need to know about the event and who have to return entry forms by a given date?

Some Districts and Groups deal with these communications most expeditiously and are to be congratulated. Sadly, I suspect that they are in the minority! Reports that filter through to me of Section Leaders not seeing "Surrey Scout" for weeks after it has arrived in the District and/or Group are most disturbing. Some, apparently, don't

see it at all.

It is bad enough that adult Leaders suffer through this communications malaise if it means that they miss the opportunity to attend vital training courses as a result; but when the younger members of the Movement are affected it really is unacceptable. The "it's tucked away behind the mantelpiece clock" syndrome - let the reader understand - has no place in today's Scouting scene!

I would therefore ask everyone concerned with the distribution of such papers to carry on the good work started by Doug each month and to make sure that they are passed on as quickly as possible to the intended recipients.

In this connection and in addition to District teams, every Group should be receiving sufficient copies of "Surrey Scout" to enable each Scouter to have a personal copy. There is no reason why such copies should not be in their hands during the first week of the relevant month together with any accompanying notices, agendas, minutes, etc.

If this is not happening please do find out what is going wrong and urge that it be put right without further delay. If the situation is still not rectified then complaints should be aired at Group, District and County meetings until we get this age old problem beaten once and for all!

GORDON BATES

County Chaplain

It's not often that we ask for a response in this feature but that's what we want this month.

Two events which we planned during the summer had to be cancelled through lack of interest and support. They were the Workshop in Scouts' Own and the Conference for Priests, Clergy and Ministers. We would like to know why there was such a poor response. Was it that we selected the wrong dates, or did we overlook some other detail in our planning or publicity?

It really would help us to know your thoughts as

we shall be meeting with the County Team shortly and possibly will be planning alternative dates. A note or a 'phone call to one of the Chaplains, or to a member of the County Team, would help us to take your thoughts into account in anything which we decide on.

Meanwhile, the three of us are always willing to take part in events and to encourage co-operation between the Scout Movement and the Church.

MICHAEL MEECH

County Secretary

COMMUNICATIONS

"Many of the problems which occur in life are attributed to failures in communication". Are many of the problems we have due to the same reason? It might be useful to examine the more common causes of communication breakdowns.

Hearing what we expect to hear.

Instead of hearing what people tell us, we hear only what we want to hear. We all tend to have preconceived ideas of what people mean. When we receive a piece of communication, we "filter out" the parts we don't want to hear, or we twist their meaning so they fit our preconceived attitudes - and we all have preconceived attitudes about Headquarters, County, District and Groups.

Feelings about the Source of the Communication

"What you ARE sounds so loudly in my ears that I cannot hear what you say".

It is extremely difficult to separate what we hear from our feelings about the person who says it. Try it the next time you watch a party political broadcast or speak to someone with whose views you don't agree. "I know just what he is going to say the minute he starts ... etc. ... etc. ... so I don't listen".

Words mean different things to different people.

There are about 600,000 words in the English

language. The average person can use about 2,000 of those. Moreover, each word has many different meanings.

Keep your communication simple.

The Effects of Emotions

When we are insecure, worried, upset or angry, what we read and hear seems suddenly to become more threatening. This is particularly common when changes are made without adequate explanation, even changes as simple as altering routines, the time or place of a meeting. REMEMBER. A Change seen as trivial by those who propose it may be seen as far more fundamental by the people directly involved.

Physical Barriers

Physical distance between people (a particular problem in our organisation) means that we all have to resort to written communication or the telephone rather than face to face communication. There is, consequently, a time lag before we receive answers of feed back. Undue delay in replying to invitations to meetings or other occasions cause problems to those who organise events especially when replies are required to assess seating arrangements, number of teas required, etc.

Perhaps we should all try to communicate better in this new Scouting year.

RAY SABIN

Leader Training Courses

Pack Holiday Course

Bentley Copse 10th/11th November

General Information Courses

Croydon - S.W. 10th November

Reigate 2nd December

Richmond 22nd & 29th January 1980

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Leatherhead 1st/2nd December

Wallington 19th/20th January 1980

Guildford 22nd/23rd March 1980

Croydon 23rd/24th February 1980

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 28th/30th March
(residential)

Croydon 24th/25th November

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 22nd/23rd March 1980

GROUP SCOUT LEADER

Croydon 8th/9th March 1980

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 16th/18th and 23rd/25th
May 1980

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 7th/8th, 21st/22nd June
and 5th/6th July 1980

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

C. Dean, 13 Greenacres, Oxted.

H. Deppart

M.B. Hymas, 7 Woodside Rd., Kingston-upon-Thames

R. Penfold, 49 Wolverton Gdns., Horley.

Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.

D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath, Lingfield.

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D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

H. Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, S.E.25.

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

J. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

Scouts

Congratulations to Patrol Leader David Cavender and the Fox Patrol of the 4th Ewell Troop on winning the County Patrol and Camping Competition this year. The results were very close, with the Beaver Patrol of 7th Reigate being just one point behind the winners. The first six placings were as follows:

1st Fox Patrol, 4th Ewell	379 points
2nd Beaver Patrol, 7th Reigate	378 "
3rd Falcon Patrol, 3rd Farnham	364 "
4th Eagle Patrol, 1st Camelsdale	360 "
5th Merlin Patrol, 1st Tadworth	351 "
6th Panther Patrol, 1st Ashford Common	348 "

It was obviously quite a task for the team of Scouts from Greater London South West to move around the thirty Patrols competing on this occasion. In thanking the judges, and Dorking District, who were responsible for the activities and domestic arrangements, I hope that the Patrols who took part benefited from the experience. Frank Fentiman, our Deputy C.C., met all the Patrols on the Sunday and he told me of the response he obtained when speaking to them - they had enjoyed the week-end's activities. That is good to hear, as I like to feel that the Scouting we offer should always be enjoyable.

At the last meeting of the County Scout Subcommittee, we discussed a wide range of topics - the Chief Scout's Award Field Test; the County Rededication Service; the Patrol and Camping Competition; SCOUTOUT '79; the 1980 Diary; Scout Proficiency Badge Scheme; Scout Publications; Camping generally. It would take too long to report on each of these areas of discussion, but I should like

to mention just two at this stage.

As you will have seen from the October issue of "Scouting", the Chief Scout's Award Field Test ended on 30th June and Headquarters has decided that the modified scheme of training should not be implemented as a package. It is very important that, as a Movement, we should undertake the occasional examination of our training structure and methods. The Field Test was an extremely valuable exercise, involving as it did Troops from all parts of the country. Our thanks go to the Troops in Surrey Heath District which participated in the Field Test - their reactions to and evaluation of the experiment were most valuable.

In considering the effectiveness of Scout Publications the County Sub-committee felt that the most useful book to have been produced in recent years was the Patrol Leader's Handbook. This, together with a series of "Scouting" Reprints gives any Troop a wealth of material on which to base programmes, training and activities. The Reprints which came in for special mention were The Patrol System, Patrol Leader Training, Troop Night Programmes, Troop Night in Pictures and More Troop Night Programmes. I should like to suggest that each Troop in the County has these particular publications in its Troop Library - if you haven't got them already I would suggest that there is no better way of spending some of your Troop funds at this time of year than to build up such a library! But it must be an "active library" with the books always in evidence at, for example, meetings of the Patrol Leaders' Council. They must not be placed away on a remote shelf to gather dust!

JIM ELLIOT

Surrey Venture Scout Rifle Club

The forecasted rain did not materialise and the Annual Club Shoot at Bisley N.R.A. Ranges on Sunday 14th October was held in warm sunshine and no wind. Approximately 100 Venture Scouts (including some 16 female Venture Scouts) gathered to try their hand and eye on the 200 yd. range. The morning was taken up with practice shooting (and some sure needed it) and the individual with the highest score was Andrew McIndoe of 1st Horsley with 43 points who won the President's Cup.

The afternoon was the time for real competition, 21 teams of 4 each had a maximum score of 200 to aim at, the highest won the County Shield. Final results were:

1st 2nd Westborough	137 points
2nd 1st Fetcham "B"	127 points
3rd 138 Banstead	121 points

Andrew McIndoe showed that the morning practice was no fluke and turned in the best score of the day of 47 out of 50 winning the Donegal Badge. Ian Pettett (2nd Westborough) was second with 43 points; Nigel Smith (also 2nd Westborough) third with 41 points.

Medals donated by the Club's President, Major General E.H. Goulburn, D.S.O., were presented by him to the members of the three best teams.

This Club is the only Scout Club affiliated to the N.R.A. (National Rifle Association) and regular Sunday practices are held at Bisley Ranges throughout the year. For more information, contact the Secretary: Terry Harrison, 56 Manor Vale, Boston Manor Road, Brentford, Middx.

Pieces and Bits

Other Publications

The editor acknowledges with thanks, the following publications recently received:

"Woodsmoke"	3rd Bookham
5th Guildford News Sheet	
Godalming District Newsletter	
"Woking Scout"	
"Scouting in Runnymede"	
"Epsom and Ewell Scout News"	
"Reigate Scouting News"	
"WASP"	Witley
"Contact"	3rd Epsom
"East Surrey District Newsletter"	
"The Surrey Mountaineer"	
"Goose Green Gazette"	Shere & Peaslake
"Surrey West Girl Guides Association News Sheet"	

Campatrol '80

This is a Catholic National Patrol Camp to be held on 16th - 30th August 1980 (come for anything from 4 - 14 days) at Linnet Clough, a magnificent County site on the edge of the Peak District. Various activities on and off site are being arranged. Further details can be obtained from John de Boer, 2 Coolgardie Ave., Chigwell, Essex.

Bowl Bridge Reservoir

This is a Southern Water Authority Reservoir with a surface water area of 770 acres and three arms stretching for up to three miles in length and is the largest inland recreational water space in Southern England. Facilities are available for Sailing, Canoeing, Rowing, Fishing, Rambling (round the 15 mile perimeter), Horse riding and Sub Aqua. Situated on the borders of Kent and East Sussex adjacent to Ticehurst and Wadhurst, special Scout and Guide weekends are arranged during 1980.

For general enquiries, contact Maurice Hemens, Lordswell Manor, Lordswell Lane, Crowborough, Tel. 2048; for the special Scout and Guide weekends, contact Peter Yates, 13 Thornhill Close, Hove, Sussex. Tel. Brighton 720077.

New Campsite

Woking District have opened their new "Birchmere" Campsite at Wisley, half a mile from the A.3. Two acres of meadow, adjacent to five square miles of wooded common. Boldermere Lake (5 Acres) suitable for canoeing, 1 mile.

Running water: flush toilets; ample wood for fires, basic charge, 20p per person per night. Enquiries to Warden: Arthur Skinner, 7 Foxlake Rd., Byfleet, WOKING. Tel: Byfleet 45865.

Congratulations

MEDAL OF MERIT

R.A.E. Wells S.L., 1st Sunbury

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

David Bailey	7th Epsom
Robert Barnes	1st Weybridge
Lindsay Blackford	7th Epsom
Simon Brewer	2nd New Haw
Simon Reed	1st Ashford Common
Matthew Sherrington	12th Farnham

County Directory

County Training Team

Peter Kinton has moved to 4 Oaks Avenue, Worcester Park. Tel. (01) 337 9212

Sunbury and Shepperton

A.D.C. (Scouts) Delete B.P. Miles

Insert P. Gray, 2 Bryan Close, Sunbury. Tel. 86395

A.D.C. (V.S.) Delete c/o D.C.

Insert R. Chesterman, 84 Gaston Way, Shepperton. Tel. Walton 28610

A.D.C. (General)

Insert A. Kane, 28 Kinross Drive, Sunbury. Tel. (01) 890 0450

A.D.C. (L.T.)

Insert P. Hill, 26 Everest Road, Stanwell. Tel. Ashford 56269

Secretary. Delete Miss J. Lloyd.

Insert Mrs. P.A. Newman, 42 Elgin Avenue, Ashford. Tel. 58412

County Diary

November

10 County Swimming Gala Guildford

December

4	Water Activities Sub-Committee	Cuddington
6	Venture Scout Sub-Committee	Dorking
11	County Finance Sub-Committee	

December "Surrey Scout"

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